The World's Publishing Houses

A LIKE® Books Guide · LIKE® Magazine

The worldwide guide of LIKE® Magazine's Books department: the publishing houses that decide what the world reads — the Big Five, the great houses of Europe, the manga powers of Japan, and the education, scholarly and independent publishers of standing. Leadership is verified name by name; scale figures appear only where the house itself publishes them, with the year stated; the gaps are named at the end.

31 publishing houses · headquarters in 11 countries · October 2026

The Big Five

Penguin Random House

New York, United States · Founded 2013 · Trade publisher (Big Five)

Parent / ownership: Bertelsmann SE & Co. KGaA (wholly owned)

Leadership: Nihar Malaviya, global Chief Executive Officer (interim from 1 Jan 2023; confirmed permanent Sep 2023; still signing as CEO in Bertelsmann H1 2026 reporting)

Principal imprints: Knopf; Viking; Penguin Press; Riverhead; Crown; Random House; Doubleday; Pantheon

Publishes: Trade fiction and nonfiction for adults, children's and young adult books, audio; more than 350 imprints in over 20 countries (Bertelsmann)

Scale: Revenue €4,981 million (2025, Bertelsmann full-year results); around 14,500 new works a year and more than 750 million print books, ebooks and audiobooks sold a year (Bertelsmann At a Glance 2026); list includes more than 80 Nobel Prize laureates (Bertelsmann)

Website: https://www.penguinrandomhouse.com · **Contact:** Author, bookseller and media contacts via penguinrandomhouse.com

Notes: Formed 1 July 2013 by the merger of Penguin (founded 1935) and Random House (founded 1927); Bertelsmann took full ownership in 2020. Its bid for Simon & Schuster was blocked in 2022.

Sources: Bertelsmann full-year 2025 results and At a Glance 2026 (revenue, titles, imprints); Publishers Weekly, H1 2026 PRH results (Malaviya as CEO); Bertelsmann announcement Sep 2023 (permanent CEO)

Hachette Livre (Hachette Book Group / Hachette UK)

Paris, France · Founded 1826 · Trade and education publisher (Big Five)

Parent / ownership: Lagardère SA (Louis Hachette Group); Lagardère chaired by Arnaud Lagardère

Leadership: David Shelley, Chief Executive Officer of Hachette Book Group (US) and Hachette UK (in post 2024; confirmed in Hachette releases of Dec 2025 and Jul 2026); Jean-Christophe Thiery, Deputy Chief Executive Officer of Hachette Livre

Principal imprints: Little, Brown and Company; Grand Central Publishing; Orbit; Basic Books; Fayard; Larousse; Grasset; Hachette Children's Group

Publishes: General fiction and nonfiction, paperbacks, children's and YA, illustrated books, travel guides, textbooks, study guides and partworks, in a dozen languages (Lagardère)

Scale: Lagardère Publishing revenue €3,001 million (2025, Lagardère/Louis Hachette Group results); over 200 imprints publishing around 15,000 new titles a year (Hachette Livre boilerplate, 2026); market leader in France, No. 2 in the UK, No. 3 in Spain and No. 3 in US trade (Lagardère)

Website: https://www.hachette.com · **Contact:** Via hachette.com; US via hachettebookgroup.com; UK via hachette.co.uk

Notes: Founded by Louis Hachette in Paris in 1826 — the group marked its bicentenary in 2026. The English-language businesses were placed under a single CEO, David Shelley, in 2024.

Sources: Lagardère/Louis Hachette Group FY2025 results (publishing revenue €3,001m); Hachette Livre governance release, lagardere.com (200+ imprints, ~15,000 titles); Hachette Book Group and Hachette UK releases Dec 2025 (Shelley as CEO)

HarperCollins

New York / London, United States / United Kingdom · Founded 1989 · Trade publisher (Big Five)

Parent / ownership: News Corp

Leadership: Brian Murray, President and Chief Executive Officer (in post since 2008; confirmed in HarperCollins UK release of 22 Oct 2025 and as AAP board chair for 2025–26); Kate Elton, CEO, HarperCollins UK (confirmed Oct 2025)

Principal imprints: Harper; William Morrow; Avon; Harlequin; Harper Voyager; Fourth Estate; HarperCollins Children's Books; Collins

Publishes: Trade fiction and nonfiction, romance (Harlequin), children's books, Christian publishing and foreign-language publishing across the US, Canada, the UK, Australia, New Zealand, Brazil, India and China

Scale: Revenue US$2.15 billion (fiscal 2025, News Corp reporting); about 4,000 employees (2025)

Website: https://www.harpercollins.com · **Contact:** Via harpercollins.com corporate and local-market sites

Notes: Name formed from Harper & Brothers (founded New York, 1817) and William Collins, Sons (founded Glasgow, 1819), combined under News Corp ownership in 1989–90. Guide founding year uses the HarperCollins combination; the predecessor houses date to 1817 and 1819 — see README discrepancy note.

Sources: News Corp fiscal 2025 reporting via company profiles (revenue US$2.15bn); HarperCollins UK corporate release, 22 Oct 2025 (Murray as President and CEO; Elton UK CEO); AAP, Feb 2025 (Murray board chair)

Macmillan Publishers

New York / London, United States / United Kingdom · Founded 1843 · Trade publisher (Big Five)

Parent / ownership: Holtzbrinck Publishing Group (Verlagsgruppe Georg von Holtzbrinck)

Leadership: Jon Yaged, Chief Executive Officer, Macmillan Publishers US (confirmed in Macmillan releases to Oct 2025 and PEN America, May 2025); Joanna Prior, CEO, Pan Macmillan UK

Principal imprints: St. Martin's Press; Farrar, Straus and Giroux; Tor; Flatiron Books; Henry Holt; Celadon Books; Picador; Macmillan Children's Publishing Group

Publishes: Adult trade fiction and nonfiction, science fiction and fantasy (Tor), children's books, audio (Macmillan Audio) and education publishing internationally through the wider Holtzbrinck group

Scale: Revenue not published separately by Holtzbrinck (private group); a figure of about US$1.4 billion circulates in secondary profiles — not officially published, so not carried as a company figure

Website: https://www.macmillan.com · **Contact:** Via macmillan.com (US) and panmacmillan.com (UK)

Notes: Founded in London in 1843 by Daniel and Alexander Macmillan; publisher of Alice's Adventures in Wonderland (1865) and The Jungle Book (1894). US and UK businesses run as Macmillan Publishers and Pan Macmillan under one Holtzbrinck ownership.

Sources: Macmillan Publishers releases, Oct 2025 (Yaged as CEO); PEN America, May 2025 (Yaged); Holtzbrinck/Macmillan company histories (1843 founding)

Simon & Schuster

New York, United States · Founded 1924 · Trade publisher (Big Five)

Parent / ownership: KKR (acquired from Paramount Global in 2023 for US$1.62 billion); standalone private company

Leadership: Greg Greeley, Chief Executive Officer (appointed to succeed Jonathan Karp, effective March 2026; former Amazon books and media executive and former president of Airbnb Homes). Jonathan Karp stepped down as CEO in 2025–26 to found and publish the Simon Six imprint

Principal imprints: Simon & Schuster (flagship); Scribner; Avid Reader Press; Gallery Books; Atria Books; Simon Six; Aladdin; Atheneum Books for Young Readers

Publishes: Adult trade fiction and nonfiction, children's books and audio; international publishing in the UK, Canada, Australia and India

Scale: Revenue not published (private company under KKR). Sale price on acquisition: US$1.62 billion (KKR, completed 30 Oct 2023)

Website: https://www.simonandschuster.com · **Contact:** Via simonandschuster.com

Notes: Founded in 1924 by Richard Simon and Max Schuster, first with crossword-puzzle books. LEADERSHIP CHANGE: the brief for this guide named Jonathan Karp; verification found he announced his departure as CEO on 26 Aug 2025 and was succeeded by Greg Greeley in March 2026. The guide prints the verified position.

Sources: Simon & Schuster announcement, 26 Aug 2025 (Karp to step down, launch Simon Six); Publishers Lunch and trade reporting, Mar 2026 (Greeley appointment); KKR/Business Wire, 30 Oct 2023 (acquisition completed, US$1.62bn)

Europe's Great Houses

Bonnier Books

Stockholm, Sweden · Founded 1837 · Publishing group

Parent / ownership: Bonnier Group (Bonnier AB), family-controlled

Leadership: Håkan Rudels, Chief Executive Officer, Bonnier Books (named as CEO in Bonnier Books' Nextory acquisition release, 1 Sep 2026); Sarah Benton and Jonathan Perdoni, joint CEOs, Bonnier Books UK (from Feb 2025)

Principal imprints: Albert Bonniers Förlag; Wahlström & Widstrand; Forum; Bonnier Carlsen; Bonnier Fakta; Zaffre (UK); BookBeat (audio/ebook service)

Publishes: Swedish and international trade fiction and nonfiction, children's books, illustrated and factual books; publishing in seven countries under more than 100 publishing houses and imprints, plus the BookBeat streaming service (Bonnier Books)

Scale: Publishing operations in seven countries and more than 100 imprints (Bonnier Books, 2026); BookBeat revenue about SEK 1.7 billion and more than 1.2 million paying users (Bonnier Books, 2026); Bonnier Books divisional revenue not published separately

Website: https://www.bonnierbooks.com · **Contact:** Via bonnierbooks.com; CEO contact published in group releases

Notes: Book publishing dates to 1837, when Albert Bonniers Förlag published its first title; the wider Bonnier Group was founded in Copenhagen in 1804. Guide founding year uses the 1837 book-publishing origin — see README.

Sources: Bonnier Books/Nextory release, 1 Sep 2026 (Rudels as CEO; seven countries; 100+ imprints; BookBeat figures); Bonnier Books UK release, 19 Feb 2025 (joint UK CEOs)

Mondadori (Arnoldo Mondadori Editore)

Segrate (Milan), Italy · Founded 1907 · Publishing group

Parent / ownership: Fininvest / Berlusconi family holding (listed, Borsa Italiana); Chairman Marina Berlusconi

Leadership: Antonio Porro, Chief Executive Officer and General Manager of the Mondadori Group (confirmed in the 2025 Annual Financial Report and board releases to 2026)

Principal imprints: Mondadori; Einaudi; Piemme; Sperling & Kupfer; Rizzoli (via Rizzoli Libri); Mondadori Electa; Frassinelli

Publishes: Trade books (Italy's largest trade publisher by market share, about 27–28% in 2025 per company/GfK reporting), education books, retail (bookstore chain), digital and media

Scale: Group revenue €931.5 million (2025, Mondadori results, Feb–Mar 2026); trade-book market share 27.4% in H1 2025 (company/GfK)

Website: https://www.mondadorigroup.com · **Contact:** Via mondadorigroup.com

Notes: Founded by Arnoldo Mondadori in 1907. Group revenue covers books, retail, digital and media, not books alone — stated as group revenue in the CSV.

Sources: Mondadori Group 2025 Annual Financial Report and board releases (Porro as CEO; revenue €931.5m); Mondadori H1 2025 presentation (trade share)

Grupo Planeta

Madrid, Spain · Founded 1949 · Publishing and media group

Parent / ownership: Lara family (family-owned)

Leadership: José Creuheras, President (Chairman) of Grupo Planeta (confirmed presenting the group's 2025 results and the 75th Premio Planeta, Oct 2026); Jesús Badenes, general manager of the publishing (Editorial) division

Principal imprints: Editorial Planeta; Seix Barral; Destino; Tusquets Editores; Espasa; Minotauro; Planeta Cómic; DeAgostini (joint venture)

Publishes: Spanish- and Portuguese-language trade fiction and nonfiction across Spain, Portugal, France and Latin America, education, and — at group level — media (Atresmedia stake) and bookstores; 70 publishing imprints (group profile)

Scale: Group turnover €2.2 billion (2025, up 5.3%, announced by the group Oct 2026 — group-wide figure including education and media, not books alone); 70 imprints, 73 bookstores, more than 15,000 employees (Grupo Planeta profile)

Website: https://www.planeta.es · **Contact:** Via planeta.es

Notes: Founded as Editorial Planeta in Barcelona in 1949 by José Manuel Lara Hernández; headquarters moved to Madrid in 2017. The Premio Planeta, founded 1952, is among the world's richest literary prizes.

Sources: Grupo Planeta results reporting, Oct 2026 (Creuheras; €2.2bn turnover 2025); Grupo Planeta official profile (70 imprints, 15,000+ employees, Creuheras as chairman)

Éditions Gallimard (Groupe Madrigall)

Paris, France · Founded 1911 · Literary publishing group

Parent / ownership: Groupe Madrigall (Gallimard family holding)

Leadership: Antoine Gallimard, President of Éditions Gallimard and Groupe Madrigall (in post since 1988; still appearing as president in Dec 2024 house press events); Charlotte and Laure Gallimard appointed managing directors of Madrigall alongside him in Apr 2023

Principal imprints: Gallimard (Blanche); Bibliothèque de la Pléiade; Folio; Gallimard Jeunesse; Denoël; Mercure de France; P.O.L; Éditions de Minuit

Publishes: Literary fiction and nonfiction, poetry, essays, children's books (including Harry Potter in French), reference editions (Pléiade) and paperbacks (Folio)

Scale: Revenue not published (private group). Catalogue measures published by profiles of the house: about 1,500 titles a year and a backlist above 20,000 titles (Publishers Weekly Global 50 profile of Madrigall) — carried as profile figures, not company accounts

Website: https://www.gallimard.fr · **Contact:** Via gallimard.fr

Notes: Founded 31 May 1911 by Gaston Gallimard as Les Éditions de la Nouvelle Revue Française. Madrigall is France's third-largest publishing group and also owns Flammarion and Casterman (see separate entry).

Sources: Groupe Madrigall and Gallimard house histories; Publishers Weekly Global 50 profile (titles/backlist); Getty/house press coverage, Dec 2024 (Antoine Gallimard as president)

Groupe Flammarion

Paris, France · Founded 1876 · Publishing group

Parent / ownership: Groupe Madrigall (acquired from RCS MediaGroup in 2012)

Leadership: Anna Pavlowitch, Présidente-directrice générale (appointed late 2022; listed as PDG in leadership listings to Apr 2025 — see README: confirmed from secondary listings, not from a 2026 house release)

Principal imprints: Flammarion; J'ai Lu; Casterman; Père Castor (Flammarion Jeunesse); Arthaud; Autrement; GF Flammarion; Pygmalion

Publishes: General literature, paperbacks (J'ai Lu), comics and bande dessinée (Casterman), children's books (Père Castor), illustrated and practical books

Scale: Revenue not published separately within Madrigall (private group)

Website: https://editions.flammarion.com · **Contact:** Via editions.flammarion.com and groupe-flammarion.com

Notes: Founded by Ernest Flammarion in 1875–76 (the guide uses 1876, the group's own dating); publisher of Zola, Maupassant and Colette. Headquarters in the former Café Voltaire, Place de l'Odéon, Paris.

Sources: Groupe Flammarion / Groupe Madrigall histories (2012 acquisition from RCS); leadership listings to Apr 2025 (Pavlowitch as PDG)

Média-Participations

Paris, France · Founded 1986 · Publishing and media group

Parent / ownership: Montagne family (family-owned, Belgian holding structure)

Leadership: Vincent Montagne, Chairman (son of the founder; in post since 2007); Claude de Saint Vincent, Chief Executive Officer (per group key-people listings). See README: English-language sources vary on the CEO title — the guide prints both titles as listed

Principal imprints: Dargaud; Dupuis; Le Lombard; Kana; Fleurus; La Martinière; Éditions du Seuil; Abrams (US)

Publishes: Franco-Belgian comics, manga (Kana) and graphic novels — Europe's leading comics publisher — plus children's and illustrated books, literature (Seuil, La Martinière) and, at group level, animation, games and magazines

Scale: Turnover €700 million (2024, group figure); more than 65 publishing and audiovisual companies and about 3,500 new releases a year across the group (group profiles)

Website: https://www.media-participations.com · **Contact:** Via media-participations.com

Notes: Founded 20 Sep 1986 by Rémy Montagne. Owns the homes of Lucky Luke (Dargaud/Lucky Comics), Spirou (Dupuis) and Blake et Mortimer (Le Lombard), and the US illustrated publisher Abrams.

Sources: Média-Participations group profiles (2024 turnover €700m; 65 companies); company key-people listings (Montagne chairman; de Saint Vincent CEO)

Egmont (Story House Egmont)

Copenhagen, Denmark · Founded 1878 · Media and publishing group

Parent / ownership: Egmont Foundation (foundation-owned)

Leadership: NOT VERIFIED TO CURRENT STANDARD — see notes. Last confirmed group President and CEO: Steffen Kragh (Egmont International Holding annual report, FY2023, signed Mar 2024). December 2025 reporting on his move to chair Tryg A/S describes his Egmont chief-executive tenure in past terms; a successor at group level could not be confirmed from official Egmont sources at press time. Publishing division: Torsten Bjerre Rasmussen was CEO of Egmont Publishing in the group's own Story House Egmont statements

Principal imprints: Story House Egmont; Cappelen Damm (Norway, co-owned); Egmont Comics; Nordisk Film (film, group); Lindhardt og Ringhof (Denmark, group)

Publishes: Children's magazines and comics in some 26 markets, books in the Nordic countries (including Norway's Cappelen Damm), and — at group level — film (Nordisk Film) and television (TV 2 Norway)

Scale: Group revenue €2.1 billion (2021, Egmont results — the most recent group figure verified in this pass; later group accounts not confirmed at press time)

Website: https://www.egmont.com · **Contact:** Via egmont.com and storyhouseegmont.com

Notes: Founded by Egmont Harald Petersen in Copenhagen in 1878; owned by the Egmont Foundation, which donates a share of profits to children and young people. Egmont sold its UK, Polish and German (Schneiderbuch) children's book businesses to HarperCollins in 2020 and refocused publishing on magazines, comics and Nordic books. LEADERSHIP GAP NAMED: group CEO not verified current — see leadership field.

Sources: Egmont International Holding annual report FY2023 (Kragh as President and CEO); Tryg A/S nomination release, Dec 2025 (Kragh's Egmont tenure described in past terms); Egmont/Story House Egmont statements (Rasmussen, Egmont Publishing); Egmont 2021 results (revenue)

Gyldendal

Copenhagen, Denmark · Founded 1770 · Publisher

Parent / ownership: Listed (Nasdaq Copenhagen); largest shareholders include Danish foundations and pension funds

Leadership: Hanne Salomonsen, Chief Executive Officer (in post since 1 Sep 2022; still listed as CEO in 2026 company reporting)

Principal imprints: Gyldendal (main); Gyldendal Business; Gyldendal Uddannelse (education); Strandberg Publishing; Forlaget Systime (education, group)

Publishes: Danish trade fiction and nonfiction, children's books, education and digital learning, and academic publishing

Scale: Revenue not published in sources verified in this pass

Website: https://www.gyldendal.dk · **Contact:** Via gyldendal.dk

Notes: Founded in 1770 by Søren Gyldendal — Denmark's oldest publishing house. NOTE ON THE BRIEF: this guide's brief listed 'Gyldendal (Norway)'. The verified Gyldendal of this entry is the Danish house; Gyldendal ASA of Norway is a separate, unrelated company (the two split in the 20th century). The Norwegian namesake is a named gap — see README.

Sources: Gyldendal A/S company reporting and leadership listings (Salomonsen CEO since Sep 2022); house history (1770 founding)

Giunti Editore

Florence, Italy · Founded 1841 · Publishing group

Parent / ownership: Giunti family (family-owned)

Leadership: Andrea Giunti, Chief Executive Officer (appointed 30 June 2025); Sergio Giunti, President

Principal imprints: Giunti; Bompiani; Giunti Junior; Giunti Psychometrics; Dami Editore; Editoriale Scienza

Publishes: Trade fiction and nonfiction (Bompiani), children's books (a historic strength — Giunti published Pinocchio), education and school publishing, psychometrics and illustrated books

Scale: Revenue not published (private group). Stake of over 30% in the UK/US Quarto Group (2025, company reporting)

Website: https://www.giunti.it · **Contact:** Via giunti.it

Notes: Origins in Florence in 1841 (as the Paggi publishing house, later Bemporad, then Giunti) — among Italy's oldest publishers. Andrea Giunti, of the family's younger generation, became CEO on 30 June 2025.

Sources: Giunti Editore leadership reporting (Andrea Giunti CEO from 30 Jun 2025); Publishers Weekly (Giunti–Quarto); house history

Springer Nature

Berlin, Germany · Founded 1842 · Scholarly and professional publisher

Parent / ownership: Listed (Frankfurt); Holtzbrinck Publishing Group is the largest shareholder

Leadership: Frank Vrancken Peeters, Chief Executive Officer (confirmed signing Springer Nature's FY2025 results, 17 Mar 2026)

Principal imprints: Nature Portfolio; Springer; BioMed Central; Palgrave Macmillan; Scientific American; Springer Medizin

Publishes: Research journals (including Nature), academic books, professional and medical publishing; more than half of its primary research articles are published open access (company, 2025)

Scale: Revenue €1,926.4 million (2025, Springer Nature FY2025 results); adjusted operating profit €543.6 million (2025)

Website: https://www.springernature.com · **Contact:** Via springernature.com

Notes: Formed in 2015 by the merger of Macmillan Science and Education with Springer Science+Business Media; the Springer house dates to Berlin, 1842 (guide founding year). Listed in Frankfurt in 2024.

Sources: Springer Nature FY2025 press release, 17 Mar 2026 (Vrancken Peeters as CEO; revenue €1,926.4m; open-access share)

Asia's Publishing Powers

Kadokawa Corporation

Tokyo (Fujimi, Chiyoda), Japan · Founded 1954 · Publisher and media group

Parent / ownership: Listed (Tokyo Stock Exchange); Sony is the largest shareholder (about 10–11%, 2025 alliance)

Leadership: Takeshi Natsuno, President and Chief Executive Officer (in post since 2021; signing company releases through Mar 2026). Note: an activist investor campaigned against his reappointment at the June 2026 AGM; the outcome was not confirmed in sources at press time — see README

Principal imprints: Kadokawa Shoten; ASCII Media Works (Dengeki); Media Factory; Enterbrain; Fujimi Shobo; Kadokawa Bunko; Yen Press (US joint venture); BookWalker (digital)

Publishes: Books, light novels, manga, magazines and ebooks, developed as intellectual property across anime, film and games ('Global Media Mix with Technology' strategy)

Scale: Revenue ¥282.9 billion (fiscal 2025, company reporting); about 5,349 employees (company profile)

Website: https://group.kadokawa.co.jp/global/ · **Contact:** Via group.kadokawa.co.jp

Notes: Publishing origins in Kadokawa Shoten, founded by Genyoshi Kadokawa in 1945; the present corporation dates from the 2014 Kadokawa–Dwango merger (guide founding year uses the 1954 incorporation of Kadokawa Shoten — see README). US manga and light-novel arm Yen Press is a joint venture with Hachette Book Group.

Sources: Kadokawa Corporation releases, Dec 2025 and Mar 2026 (Natsuno as President and CEO); company profile (FY2025 revenue, employees); Oasis Management campaign materials, June 2026 (AGM opposition — outcome unconfirmed)

Kodansha

Tokyo (Bunkyo), Japan · Founded 1909 · Publisher

Parent / ownership: Noma family (family-owned private company; Noma Cultural Foundation)

Leadership: Yoshinobu Noma, President and Chief Executive Officer (in post since 2011; confirmed on Kodansha's official corporate site, 2026)

Principal imprints: Kodansha (main); Weekly Shonen Magazine; Morning; Nakayoshi; Gunzo; Kobunsha; Kodansha USA; King Records (music, group)

Publishes: Manga (Attack on Titan; Weekly Shonen Magazine), literary and general books, magazines, children's books and dictionaries; stories licensed worldwide in many languages

Scale: Revenue not published (private company)

Website: https://www.kodansha.co.jp · **Contact:** Via kodansha.co.jp and kodansha.com

Notes: Founded in 1909 by Seiji Noma; Japan's largest general publisher by profile. The Noma family has led the house across four generations.

Sources: Kodansha official corporate site (Noma as President and CEO; 1909 founding); company profiles

Shueisha

Tokyo (Chiyoda), Japan · Founded 1926 · Publisher

Parent / ownership: Hitotsubashi Group (Oga family)

Leadership: Shinichi Hirono, President and Chief Executive Officer (per company key-people listings). DISCREPANCY FLAGGED: a Nikkei report quoted in secondary coverage names a 'President Hideaki Hayashi' for Shueisha; the guide prints Hirono from company listings and flags the conflict in the README

Principal imprints: Weekly Shonen Jump; Jump SQ; Shonen Jump+ (digital); V Jump; Non-no; Margaret; Dash X Bunko; Viz Media (US, with Shogakukan)

Publishes: Manga magazines and volumes (One Piece, Jujutsu Kaisen, Demon Slayer: Kimetsu no Yaiba in translation partnerships), light novels, literary and educational books and magazines

Scale: Revenue not published (private company). Weekly Shonen Jump print circulation 1,026,667 (Jul–Sep 2025, Japan Magazine Publishers Association figure)

Website: https://www.shueisha.co.jp/en/ · **Contact:** Via shueisha.co.jp

Notes: Created in 1925 as the entertainment division of Shogakukan and incorporated separately on 8 Aug 1926 (guide founding year). With Shogakukan it owns Viz Media in the United States.

Sources: Shueisha company listings (Hirono, president and CEO); JMPA circulation figure via Weekly Shonen Jump records (2025); Hitotsubashi Group histories

Shogakukan

Tokyo (Chiyoda), Japan · Founded 1922 · Publisher

Parent / ownership: Hitotsubashi Group (Oga family)

Leadership: Nobuhiro Oga, President and Chief Executive Officer (signed the company's human-rights policy dated 19 Mar 2026 as President and CEO)

Principal imprints: Shogakukan (main); CoroCoro Comic; Weekly Shonen Sunday; Big Comic; Sho-Comi; Shogakukan Creative; Viz Media (US, with Shueisha)

Publishes: Manga (Doraemon; Detective Conan), magazines, light novels, dictionaries and reference, literature, nonfiction and educational books

Scale: Revenue ¥108.471 billion (2023, company reporting); 707 employees (2024)

Website: https://www.shogakukan.co.jp · **Contact:** Via shogakukan.co.jp

Notes: Founded 8 Aug 1922 by Takeo Oga, first as a publisher of educational magazines for schoolchildren — the name means 'elementary school building'. Parent of the Hitotsubashi Group alongside Shueisha and Hakusensha.

Sources: Shogakukan official human-rights policy, 19 Mar 2026 (Oga as President and CEO); company profile (2023 revenue; 2024 employees)

Education, Scholarship & The Independents

Scholastic

New York, United States · Founded 1920 · Children's and education publisher

Parent / ownership: Listed (Nasdaq); Robinson family holds controlling voting interest

Leadership: Peter Warwick, President and Chief Executive Officer (in post since 2021; confirmed in Scholastic fiscal 2026 results releases, Sep and Dec 2025)

Principal imprints: Scholastic Press; Graphix; Arthur A. Levine (legacy); Scholastic Education; Scholastic Book Fairs; Scholastic Book Clubs; 9 Story Media Group (entertainment, group)

Publishes: Children's trade books (The Hunger Games, Harry Potter in the US, Dog Man, Wings of Fire), graphic novels (Graphix), school Book Fairs and Book Clubs, classroom education and children's media

Scale: Revenue published in Scholastic's SEC reporting by fiscal year (see investor.scholastic.com); the guide does not carry a single-year figure here because the fiscal 2026 full-year release postdates this pass — marked not carried rather than estimated

Website: https://www.scholastic.com · **Contact:** Via scholastic.com and investor.scholastic.com

Notes: Founded in 1920 by Maurice R. Robinson as a classroom magazine publisher. US publisher of Harry Potter and The Hunger Games; Graphix is a leading children's graphic-novel imprint.

Sources: Scholastic fiscal 2026 Q1/Q2 results releases, Sep and Dec 2025 (Warwick as President and CEO; Dog Man, Hunger Games, Harry Potter performance)

Bloomsbury Publishing

London, United Kingdom · Founded 1986 · Trade and academic publisher

Parent / ownership: Listed (London Stock Exchange, FTSE 250); independent

Leadership: Nigel Newton, founder — Chief Executive until Sep 2026, then Executive Chairman under a five-year succession plan announced 8 Sep 2026 (Reuters); a new chief executive is to be appointed within two years, with deputy chairman John Bason leading the search. The guide prints the transition, not the old title alone

Principal imprints: Bloomsbury (main); Bloomsbury Academic; Bloomsbury Children's Books; Raven Books; A&C Black; Rowman & Littlefield (acquired 2024); Bloomsbury Digital Resources

Publishes: Trade fiction and nonfiction (the Harry Potter books in the UK), children's books, academic and professional publishing, cookery and illustrated books

Scale: Revenue £361 million (year ended 28 Feb 2025, Bloomsbury audited results); profit before tax £42 million (2025 results, company presentation)

Website: https://www.bloomsbury.com · **Contact:** Via bloomsbury.com

Notes: Founded in 1986 by Nigel Newton and three fellow publishers; floated in 1994. Publisher of the Year at the British Book Awards 2025 (company). The Sep 2026 succession announcement is this guide's clearest leadership-transition entry — see README.

Sources: Bloomsbury audited preliminary results, year ended 28 Feb 2025 (Newton as Founder and Chief Executive; revenue £361m); Reuters, 8 Sep 2026 (Newton to executive chairman; CEO search within two years)

Pearson

London, United Kingdom · Founded 1844 · Education publisher and learning company

Parent / ownership: Listed (London Stock Exchange / NYSE); independent

Leadership: Omar Abbosh, Chief Executive (in post since Jan 2024; confirmed in Pearson's 2025 annual report and results, Feb 2026)

Principal imprints: Pearson Education; Edexcel; Pearson VUE (Professional Assessments); Pearson English Language Learning; Savvas Learning (US schools, partner); PTE (Pearson Test of English)

Publishes: Educational content, assessments and qualifications, higher-education courseware, English-language learning and workforce skills — now primarily digital and service-based rather than textbook-led

Scale: Sales £3,577 million (2025, Pearson preliminary results); adjusted operating profit £614 million (2025)

Website: https://www.pearson.com · **Contact:** Via pearson.com and plc.pearson.com

Notes: Founded as a construction company in 1844 and long the owner of Penguin Books, which it placed into the Penguin Random House merger in 2013 before exiting publishing ownership in 2019–20; today's Pearson is an education and assessment company and is included as the scale benchmark of education publishing.

Sources: Pearson 2025 annual report and preliminary results (Abbosh as Chief Executive; sales £3,577m)

Wiley (John Wiley & Sons)

Hoboken, New Jersey, United States · Founded 1807 · Scholarly and professional publisher

Parent / ownership: Listed (NYSE); Wiley family remains closely involved (Jesse Wiley chairs the board)

Leadership: Matthew Kissner, President and Chief Executive Officer (interim from Oct 2023; made permanent Jul 2024; confirmed in Wiley releases to June 2026)

Principal imprints: Wiley (main); Wiley-VCH; Jossey-Bass; For Dummies; Wiley Blackwell; Emerald Publishing (acquired 2026)

Publishes: Scientific, technical, medical and scholarly journals and books, professional and education titles; a leader in open-access research publishing and AI content licensing

Scale: Revenue US$1,678 million (fiscal 2025, Wiley results); operating income US$221 million (fiscal 2025)

Website: https://www.wiley.com · **Contact:** Via wiley.com

Notes: Founded in New York in 1807 — one of the oldest continuously operating US publishers. Acquired Emerald Publishing in June 2026.

Sources: Wiley fiscal 2025 results release (Kissner as President and CEO; revenue US$1,678m); Business Wire, Jul 2024 and Jun 2026 (permanent appointment; Emerald acquisition)

McGraw Hill

New York, United States · Founded 1888 · Education publisher

Parent / ownership: Listed (NYSE, IPO Jul 2025); Platinum Equity retains majority ownership

Leadership: Philip Moyer, President and Chief Executive Officer (from 9 Feb 2026; former Google Cloud AI executive and former Vimeo CEO). Simon Allen retired as President and CEO on 9 Feb 2026 and continues as

chairman — verified in the company's SEC filing of Jan 2026

Principal imprints: McGraw Hill Education; ALEKS (adaptive learning); Achieve3000; Boards & Beyond; McGraw Hill Professional (legacy); Redbird Advanced Learning

Publishes: K-12 and higher-education course materials, adaptive and AI-powered learning platforms, professional and medical education

Scale: Fiscal 2026 revenue guidance US$2,031–2,061 million (company guidance, Nov 2025) — guidance, not a reported result, and labelled as such

Website: https://www.mcgrawhill.com · **Contact:** Via mcgrawhill.com

Notes: Origins in 1888 (James H. McGraw's publishing ventures); the education company was separated from McGraw-Hill Financial (now S&P Global) in 2013, bought by Platinum Equity in 2021 for US$4.7 billion and listed in 2025. LEADERSHIP CHANGE verified by SEC filing — see leadership field.

Sources: McGraw Hill SEC Form 8-K, Jan 2026 (Allen retirement; Moyer appointment effective 9 Feb 2026); Education Week MarketBrief, Jan 2026; McGraw Hill fiscal Q2 2026 results (guidance)

W. W. Norton & Company

New York, United States · Founded 1923 · Independent trade and college publisher

Parent / ownership: Employee-owned (ownership transferred to employees by Mary Dows Herter Norton from 1952)

Leadership: Julia A. Reidhead, Chairman and President (in post since 2016; confirmed in Pace University and trade profiles, 2025)

Principal imprints: W. W. Norton (main); Liveright; Countryman Press; Norton Professional Books; Norton Young Readers; The Norton Anthologies; Norton Library

Publishes: Trade fiction and nonfiction, poetry, college textbooks and the Norton Anthologies, professional books and children's books — 'Books That Live'

Scale: Revenue not published (private, employee-owned). About 630 employees (company profile at its 2023 centenary)

Website: https://www.wwnorton.com · **Contact:** Via wwnorton.com

Notes: Founded in 1923 by William Warder Norton and Mary Dows Herter Norton from lectures at the People's Institute, Cooper Union. The largest independent, employee-owned publisher in the United States (company).

Sources: W. W. Norton centenary profiles, Publishers Weekly and Shelf Awareness (Reidhead as chairman and president; employee ownership; staff); Pace University MS in Publishing, Dec 2025 (Reidhead)

Grove Atlantic

New York, United States · Founded 1993 · Independent literary publisher

Parent / ownership: Independent (owned by its partners, including Morgan Entrekin)

Leadership: Morgan Entrekin, President, Publisher and Chief Executive Officer (confirmed in Publishers Weekly and PEN America profiles)

Principal imprints: Grove Press; Atlantic Monthly Press; The Mysterious Press; Black Cat; Roxane Gay Books

Publishes: Literary fiction, nonfiction, poetry, drama and translations — about 100 titles a year (PEN America profile)

Scale: Revenue not published (private). About 100 titles a year (company profile)

Website: https://www.groveatlantic.com · **Contact:** Via groveatlantic.com

Notes: Created in 1993 by the merger of Grove Press (founded 1951; publisher of the Beats) and Atlantic Monthly Press (founded 1917) — the house styles itself 'an independent literary publisher since 1917' (guide founding year uses the 1993 merger). Co-founded Literary Hub in 2015.

Sources: Grove Atlantic company profiles; PEN America (Entrekin, president and publisher; ~100 titles a year); Publishers Weekly (executive committee; Entrekin as CEO and publisher)

Chronicle Books

San Francisco, United States · Founded 1967 · Independent publisher

Parent / ownership: McEvoy Group (Chronicle Books, Galison/Mudpuppy, Princeton Architectural Press)

Leadership: Tyrrell Mahoney, President (in post since Jan 2017; elected chair of the Association of American Publishers for 2026–27, Jan 2026)

Principal imprints: Chronicle Books (main); Chronicle Prism; Laurence King (UK, group distribution); Galison (gift, group); Mudpuppy (children's gift, group); Princeton Architectural Press (group)

Publishes: Illustrated and lifestyle books — art, food, wellness, humour, children's books, pop culture, travel and photography — plus journals, games and gift products

Scale: Revenue not published (private)

Website: https://www.chroniclebooks.com · **Contact:** Via chroniclebooks.com; HQ +1 415-537-4200 (published)

Notes: Founded in San Francisco in 1967 by Phelps Dewey; named for the San Francisco Chronicle newspaper tradition of its founders. Also a major distributor for independent publishers.

Sources: Association of American Publishers, Jan 2026 (Mahoney, president of Chronicle Books, elected AAP chair); Publishers Weekly (Mahoney succession, 2017); Chronicle Books company profiles (1967 founding)

Sourcebooks

Naperville, Illinois, United States · Founded 1987 · Independent publisher

Parent / ownership: Independent; Penguin Random House holds a 45% minority stake (2019)

Leadership: Dominique Raccah, Publisher and Chief Executive Officer and founder (confirmed in 2025–26 profiles; chairs the Sourcebooks management board)

Principal imprints: Sourcebooks Casablanca (romance); Sourcebooks Fire (YA); Sourcebooks Jabberwocky (children's); Sourcebooks Wonderland; Poisoned Pen Press; Cumberland House; Bloom Books

Publishes: Adult fiction (including a leading romance programme), young adult and children's books, calendars and gift books; described by Publishers Weekly as among the most successful self-made US publishers of the 21st century

Scale: Revenue not published (private). Publishes hundreds of new titles a year (company profiles); ranked among the largest US trade publishers by trade reporting

Website: https://www.sourcebooks.com · **Contact:** Via sourcebooks.com

Notes: Founded by Dominique Raccah from her home in Naperville in 1987 with US$17,000 from her retirement account (her published account). The largest woman-owned trade publisher in North America (company). PRH's 45% stake (2019) is a minority investment; Sourcebooks remains independently managed.

Sources: Publishers Weekly (PRH 45% stake, 2019; Raccah chairs board); Susquehanna University lecture profile, Feb 2026 (Raccah as publisher and CEO); Sourcebooks company profiles

Canongate Books

Edinburgh, United Kingdom · Founded 1973 · Independent publisher

Parent / ownership: Independent (management-owned since the 1994 buyout led by Jamie Byng)

Leadership: Jamie Byng, Chief Executive Officer, Publisher and Managing Director (confirmed in The Bookseller reporting through 2026)

Principal imprints: Canongate (main); Canongate Classics; Severn House (sold to Joffe Books, announced Nov 2025); Payback Press (legacy); Rebel Inc. (legacy)

Publishes: Literary fiction and nonfiction, memoir and the Canons classics programme; publisher of Life of Pi and of Barack Obama's memoirs in the UK market historically

Scale: Revenue not published in sources verified in this pass. In 2026 Canongate moved its authors to quarterly royalty payments, a first among major UK trade houses (The Bookseller)

Website: https://www.canongate.co.uk · **Contact:** Via canongate.co.uk

Notes: Founded in Edinburgh in 1973; bought out of receivership in 1994 by Jamie Byng. A certified B Corporation. British Book Awards Publisher of the Year in 2003 and 2009.

Sources: The Bookseller, 2026 (Byng as CEO; quarterly royalties; London Book Fair 2026); Publishers Lunch, Nov 2025 (Severn House sale; Byng as CEO); Canongate company history

Faber and Faber (Faber)

London, United Kingdom · Founded 1929 · Independent publisher

Parent / ownership: Independent (privately owned)

Leadership: Mary Cannam, Chief Executive (in post since 1 Apr 2023; confirmed as chief executive in Faber statements of 2024); Stephen Page, Executive Chair

Principal imprints: Faber (main); Faber Poetry; Faber Drama; Faber Children's; Faber Music (separate company, group); Faber Academy (writing courses)

Publishes: Fiction, poetry (T. S. Eliot was its first poetry editor), drama, film, nonfiction and children's books; authors have included 13 Nobel laureates (company profile)

Scale: Revenue not published (private)

Website: https://www.faber.co.uk · **Contact:** Via faber.co.uk

Notes: Founded in 1929; publisher of T. S. Eliot, W. H. Auden, Samuel Beckett, Harold Pinter and Kazuo Ishiguro. Sponsors the PEN Pinter Prize (from 2024).

Sources: The Bookseller (Cannam appointed chief executive, Apr 2023; Faber PEN Pinter sponsorship statement by Cannam as chief executive, 2024); Faber company profiles

Allen & Unwin

Sydney (Crows Nest), Australia · Founded 1914 · Independent publisher

Parent / ownership: Independent (Australian management buyout, 1990); founder-chairman Patrick Gallagher

Leadership: Robert Gorman, Chief Executive Officer (in post since 2008, per company and industry profiles; listed as CEO in current IBISWorld company profile). See README: confirmed from industry profiles rather than a 2026 house release

Principal imprints: Allen & Unwin (main); Allen & Unwin Children's; A&U New Zealand; Murdoch Books (cooking/lifestyle, acquired); Albert Street Books

Publishes: Literary and commercial fiction, nonfiction, children's and young adult books — up to about 250 new titles a year (company history); also represents Bloomsbury, Faber, Canongate and other UK independents in Australia and New Zealand

Scale: Revenue not published by the company (a third-party estimate of about A$90.8 million for 2025 circulates in IBISWorld profiles — third-party estimate, not a company figure, and not carried as such)

Website: https://www.allenandunwin.com · **Contact:** Via allenandunwin.com (including the Friday Pitch submissions route)

Notes: Australian house with origins in the London firm George Allen & Unwin (1914); the Australian company became independent in 1990 and is Australia's leading independent publisher, voted Australian Publisher of the Year twelve times (company history). Guide founding year uses the 1914 London origin — see README.

Sources: Allen & Unwin company history (independence 1990; ~250 titles a year; Publisher of the Year record); IBISWorld company profile (Gorman as CEO; third-party revenue estimate flagged as such)

Named Gaps

China's publishing groups could not be verified to house standard in English-language official sources in this pass and are the guide's largest geographic gap. India's trade majors, Brazil's and the Arabic world's leading houses, Russia's groups, and Gyldendal ASA of Norway (a separate company from the Danish Gyldendal in this guide) are likewise named gaps. Egmont's group chief executive could not be verified current at press time and is flagged inside its entry. Full method, counts and discrepancies are in the README accompanying the master CSV.

LIKE® Books · likeleaders.com · Compiled October 2026. Company figures are labelled as such; leadership reflects official sources at press time.